

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with direct international arbitration experience gained during a year-long placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP, where I supported a complex investment arbitration from procedural stages through to memorial preparation. Experienced in evidence review, drafting procedural documents, maintaining structured case files, tracking deadlines and coordinating documents under pressure. LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution (Merit, Queen Mary) provides strong legal research and procedural analytical skills. Additional background in real estate disputes, data privacy advisory work and client-facing legal advice at Citizens Advice.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Studied international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, jurisdictional issues, evidence and legal research at postgraduate level
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy): 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — mark 55

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, with partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research on substantive and procedural issues
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines across the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

- Prepared client notes; maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and deadline tracking

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a caseload independently from instruction to submission: takes detailed client statements, establishes chronologies, identifies legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Researches complex legal points across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters